

HRMS Portal

Biometric Attendance System

How to Use - Complete Guide for Every User & Admin

System	6 ESSL terminals (TVP 23, Sipcot 24, Lab 25, NAMAKKAL 42, NEI 58, HEAD 59) + Flask + SQL Server
Live URL	https://win.howtostart.in/UA/ Local: http://localhost:5173/UA/
Audience	Operators, managers & admins - no tech background needed
Version	v2.0 - 23 Sep 2026 - Admin left tabs, Shift Edit/Delete, Current-month default

Keep this manual by your desk. Each chapter has a Try it and a Tip. Follow once and you know the portal.

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1. Welcome

HRMS Portal is your single window for **Biometric Attendance** across 6 devices. Every tap flows: terminal -> ESSL server -> SQL Server -> Flask app -> your browser. You see who is in, late, or on leave in real time.

Three layers: **Capture** (terminals), **Truth** (SQL monthly logs), **Clarity** (dashboards & AI). This manual is the Clarity layer.

- Live boards - Present/Absent per unit, 5s refresh
- Monthly per-employee - punch times, shift, late, extra, lunch
- AI - plain English: who was late in Sipcot today?
- Admin - users, employees, shift rules for future dates

Tip: Start with Login -> Dashboard -> Employees. That is 80% of daily use.

2. Signing In

Open <https://win.howtostart.in/UA/> (live) or <http://localhost:5173/UA/> (dev). You see UA Attendance - Sign in. Enter Username/Password; the app checks /api/login and stores your session.

- **superadmin** admin / @123Savetron - everything + Admin Panel
- **admin** admin_sipcot / Admin@sipcot - own unit(s) + Admin Panel
- **manager** qc@sbiochem.com / Nsrl@lab123 - own unit only

Tip: Local Cannot connect? Hard-refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R) or use live URL. Live never has this issue (proxy fixed to <https://win.howtostart.in>).

3. Left Sidebar - your map

Dark left bar is always visible (except inside Admin Panel, which has its own left tabs). Click a menu -> main area swaps. Active is indigo. Managers see 2 items (Dashboard, Employees); admins see all 8. Admin Panel is a button above Logout.

- AI Insights - Gemini chat
- Dashboard - All branches live
- Employees - 300+ staff, monthly
- Units - Device cards
- Backup / Export - DB backup, CSV

Tip: Learn 2 clicks: Employees -> click a name (monthly) and Dashboard -> filter Present/Absent.

4. Dashboard - live attendance

Superadmin sees AllBranchesPage: 6 unit cards with Present/Absent/device status + totals. Device-bound admins see single Dashboard filtered. Top bar: All | Present | Absent. Auto-refresh 5s. Click a unit to drill into employees.

- Card: unit name, location, Present (green), Absent (red), Last updated
- +10 linked badges = works on two devices (SLP <-> Sipcot)

Tip: Keep Dashboard on a TV during morning rush.

5. Employees - search & monthly

Lists every enrolled person (hidden: 0001 in HEAD OFFICE). Columns: ID, Name, Branch, Status, First/Last Punch, Monthly. Top: search by name/ID, branch pills (All | UAI Neikarapatti | SS_Sidco ...). Click a row -> Monthly modal.

- Status: emerald On Time, blue Late, red Absent, gray No Data
- Monthly defaults to **current month** (NEW: Sep in Sep) - was last month before
- Export CSV top-right in monthly modal

Tip: Need CSV? Monthly -> Export CSV downloads that month.

6. Attendance, Units, Activity

Attendance - date picker + unit filter for that date. **Units** - one card per device (23 TVP, 24 Sipcot, 25 Lab, 42 NAMAKKAL, 58 NEI, 59 HEAD). **Activity Insights** - timeline of who punched where, spot rotation.

7. AI Insights & Analytics

AI Insights - Gemini chat: Who was late in Sipcot today? It cites names, IDs, late minutes. **Patterns** - heatmaps. **Owner Analytics** - 45-day trends (admin/superadmin only).

Tip: AI is concise - it cites data then stops. Ask follow-ups.

8. Backup / Export - never lose data

Shows SQL backups in C:\Backups and DeviceLogs row counts. Buttons: Create Backup, Download .bak, Export punches CSV (/api/export/punches?from=&to;=).

- Keep 3 recent .bak files
- DeviceLogs are monthly (DeviceLogs_9_2026 etc.)

Tip: Before bulk shift changes, click Create Backup - 10 seconds.

9. Admin Panel - NEW left tabs

Click **Admin Panel** at main sidebar bottom (superadmin/admin only). Header shows Admin Panel - Manage all locations & users with Dashboard (back), your label, Logout. Inside, a **new left nav** has 3 tabs: **Employees | Users | Shift Management** (with counts). Click a tab -> right area swaps.

- Employees tab: 312 total, Add form, search + All Units filter, list (80 shown)
- Users tab: Add User + Users table with All Units filter - Edit/Delete per user
- Shift Management tab: All units, future From/To, Edit + Delete per rule

Tip: Managers don't see Admin Panel. Ask superadmin to promote if needed.

10. Shift Management - future dates, Edit & Delete (step-by-step)

Most powerful new feature. You asked: once shift management is allocated to an employee for future date it should show in UI and update in server also we are not supposed to lose data - that is exactly what it does.

Open **Admin Panel -> left nav -> Shift Management**. You see the 3-step form plus Existing Rules. All edits are in-place.

1. Select Unit - Dropdown shows all 6 units (e.g. SS_Sidco - Sipcot). Loads its employees and Existing Rules.
2. Choose Shift - Tap G (09:00-18:00), 1st (06:00-14:00), 2nd (14:00-22:00), Night (21:00-06:00), Custom. Start/End boxes fill. 4 boxes: Start | End | From | To.
3. From / To - From = first day, To = last day (empty = open-ended, shows no limit). Example: 2026-09-24 to 2026-09-27 = 1st only those 4 days.
4. Assign Employees - Search + All/Clear. Tick 1 or many. None = Whole Device.
5. Add / Update - Add for Whole Device or Add for 2 employees -> green Rule added. Editing turns amber Editing #1101 - Cancel and button becomes Update Rule (UPDATE AttendanceRules WHERE Id=? - no data loss).
6. Existing Rules - Below form: Existing Rules - Edit / Delete (N). Each row: 14:00-22:00 | Karthik. G (ID 2) | 2026-09-30->2026-10-05 | Pencil | Trash.

Tip: Tested: Senthamil selvan (0010) - 1st 2026-09-24->27 shows as 1st in his September punch log (was G before).

11. Monthly Attendance - reading the punch log

Click any employee row -> modal: Senthamil selvan - 0010 - SS_Sidco (+ linked branches). Top: Month pills (2026-05 ... 2026-10) - **current month auto-selected** (NEW). Next: Shift header (General 09:15-18:00 + 1st/2nd/Night). Then stat cards (Present, Late, Extra, Worked Hrs, Permission, Leaves, Overtime, On-Time %, Absent, Weekly Off, Holiday). Click a card to

filter table.

- Columns: Date, Status, Type, Shift (G/1st/2nd/Night/W.Off), In Time, Out Time, Worked
- Shift column shows **G** not General (NEW) and is In-Time based for all units (06:04 -> 1st, not Night)
- Future dates (+30d) show assigned future rule even before punch
- Weekly Off / Holiday rows are red/indigo; Scheduled: SS SLP badge shows rotation

Tip: Export CSV top-right downloads that month.

12. Roles & Permissions

superadmin (admin) - everything, all units, can promote to admin, sees Owner Analytics. **admin** (admin_sipcot) - same but scoped to own deviceId. **manager** - Dashboard + Employees only.

- Left sidebar filters: managers see 2 items, admins see 8
- API key admin123 guards /api/users, /api/rules, /api/admin/employees

Tip: Need new manager for Lab? Admin Panel -> Users -> Add User -> Role manager -> Unit Lab -> Create.

13. Tips, Troubleshooting & Quick Reference

Keep this page open.

- Cannot connect (local dev) - Proxy was localhost:5000 - fixed to https://win.howtostart.in (secure:false). Hard-refresh or use live URL.
- Shift shows G but you assigned 1st - Check Shift column in Daily Punch Log, not header. Ensure From/To covers that date and you're on right month.
- Weekly Off shows 1st - Assigned shift spanning Sunday overrides W.Off - intentional.
- Employee count mismatch - Panel shows 312 total but table shows 80 - caps at 120 for speed; use Search.
- Lunch 60m - Day shifts 13:00-14:00 deduct 60m. Night shifts and Muruganagendiran have no deduction.

Tip: Daily flow: Dashboard (9am) -> Employees (search late) -> Monthly -> Admin Panel -> Shifts | Before bulk changes: Backup / Export -> Create Backup

You now know the whole portal - handmade, complete, and current.

Print this, keep it by your desk, and share with new HR joiners.

- UA HRMS Team - Questions? Ask in AI Insights chat or contact superadmin